

ADÈLE HÉNOT-MORTIER

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Broad:

Semantics, Pragmatics, Experimental and Computational Linguistics.

Narrow:

Theory and Processing of Scalar Implicatures;

Semantics and Pragmatics of Questions;

Statistical models of Language.

EMPLOYMENT

Lecturer in Linguistics and AI, Queen Mary University of London

2025 – present

Department of Linguistics, tenure-track equivalent.

EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics, MIT

2019 – 2025

Thesis title: *Oddness under Discussion*

Committee: Amir Anvari (chair); Athulya Aravind (chair); Daniel Fox; Martin Hackl; Viola Schmitt

Master's ("M2") in Cognitive Science Science (CogMaster) @ENS

2018 – 2019

Specialization: Linguistics

Thesis title: *Semantics and Pragmatics of numerical approximation expressions*

Advisors: Paul Égré & Benjamin Spector.

Master's ("M2") in Computer Science (MPRI) @Paris 7

2017 – 2018

Specialization: Logic and Semantics of Programming Languages

Thesis title: *Incremental dialogue modeling*

Advisor: Jonathan Ginzburg

B.A. ("M1") in Modern & Comparative Literature @Paris 3

2014 – 2018

Specialization: Comparative Literature

Dual Bachelor ("M1") @Télécom Paris & HEC Paris

2014 – 2017

Specializations: Algorithmics, Cryptography & Management

Classes préparatoires (freshman/sophomore) @Lycée Saint Louis

2012 – 2014

Specialization: Physics and Engineering Science

SUMMER SCHOOLS

The 6th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (as TA)

Summer 2024

The 4th Crete Summer School of Linguistics

Summer 2022

The 33rd European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information

Summer 2022

The 2nd Crete Summer School of Linguistics

Summer 2018

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

- ◆ With Steven Verheyen, Benjamin Spector and Paul Égré. How Vague Words Shape Interpretation: Evidence from Approximators. Under review.
- ◆ It's tough to be pretty: on the semantic relatedness between *tough* and *pretty* predicates. Under review.
- ◆ With Paul Égré, Benjamin Spector, and Steven Verheyen. On the optimality of vagueness: “around”, “between” and the Gricean maxims. *Linguistics and Philosophy* 46, 1075–1130 (2023). [\[Paper\]](#)

PEER-REVIEWED CONTRIBUTIONS TO EDITED VOLUMES

- ◆ “Small” vectors in big spaces, and the semantics of French -et(te)-suffixation. In A. Alexiadou and R. Kramer (Eds.), *Systems of Nominal Classification: Morphology, Syntax and Semantics*. De Gruyter. To appear.
- ◆ Highs and Lows of the French diminutive suffix -et(te). In *Lingue e linguaggio* (2024). [\[Paper\]](#)

PEER-REVIEWED PROCEEDINGS PUBLICATIONS

2026

- ◆ “Remind-me” presuppositions with iterated Speech Acts. *Proceedings of the 36th meeting of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT 36)*, to appear.
- ◆ Oh shoot here we go again. *Proceedings of the 48th Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW)*, to appear.

2025

- ◆ Covert operators are picked to minimize QuD-ambiguity: the view from pex and only. *Proceedings of the 30th Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB 30)*, to appear. [\[Preprint\]](#).
- ◆ Complementarity over competition in grammatical exhaustification. *Proceedings of the 35th meeting of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT 35)*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#).
- ◆ Repairing bad questions makes for good assertions: the case of but and at least. *Proceedings of the 61st annual meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS 61)*. [\[Preprint\]](#).

2024

- ◆ Scalarity, information structure and relevance in varieties of Hurford Conditionals. *Proceedings of the 2024 Amsterdam Colloquium (AC2024)*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#).
- ◆ “One tool to rule them all”? An integrated model of the QuD for Hurford sentences. *Proceedings of the Special Session “Does semantics have a ‘too many tools’ problem?” of the 29th Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#).
- ◆ Unifying the French evidential construction *on di(rai)t que*. *Proceedings of the Special Session “Evidentials in non-canonical Speech Acts” of the 29th Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)*, to appear [\[Paper\]](#).
- ◆ Redundancy under Discussion. *Proceedings of the 29th Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ The French demonstrative paradigm: structurally transparent but semantically intricate. *Proceedings of the 54rd Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS 54)*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#)

2023

- ◆ Shallowly accurate but deeply confused – how language models deal with antonyms, *Proceedings of the 28th Sinn und Bedeutung Conference*, to appear. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ Do Language Models discriminate between relatives and pseudorelatives? *Proceedings of the 2023 CLASP Conference on Learning with Small Data*, 55–61, Gothenburg, Sweden. Association for Computational Linguistics. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ “Bridging the gap” between French tough-constructions and pseudorelatives, *Proceedings of the 25th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar*, 156–167. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ Superiority effects and the French Plural Pronoun Construction, *Proceedings of the 47th Penn Linguistics Conference*, 67–76. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ With Ido Benbaji-Elhadad and Omri Doron. Distinguishing levels of morphological derivation in word-embedding models, *Proceedings of the 53rd Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society*, 63–76. [\[Paper\]](#)

2022

- ◆ Alternatives are blind to some but not all kinds of context: the view from Hurford Disjunctions, *Proceedings of Sinn Und Bedeutung*, 27, 291–308. [\[Paper\]](#).
- ◆ An AGREE-based account of the gap distribution in tough-constructions vs gapped-degree phrases, *Proceedings of the 24th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar*, 40–58. [\[Paper\]](#)
- ◆ With Ido Benbaji-Elhadad and Omri Doron. Word-embeddings distinguish denominal and root-derived verbs in Semitic, *Proceedings of End-to-End Compositional Models of Vector-Based Semantics*, 35–49. [\[Paper\]](#)

2015

- ◆ With Sergey Kabanikhin, Olga Krivorotko, Dmitriy Voronov and Darya Yermolenko. A numerical algorithm of parameter estimation for dynamic model for HIV infection of CD4+ t cells. *2015 International Conference on Biomedical Engineering and Computational Technologies (SIBIRCON)*, 180–185, IEEE. [\[Paper\]](#)

INVITED TALKS

- ◆ *Semantics talk TBD*, University of Geneva, November 17, 2026 (upcoming).
- ◆ *Oddness, logical compatibility, and granularity*, Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics (ZAS), June 5, 2026.
- ◆ *“Small” vectors in big spaces, and the semantics of French -et(te)-suffixation*, Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics (ZAS), June 3, 2026.
- ◆ *Flavors of Oddness*, University College London, November 19, 2025. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *Syntax and grounding in adjective learning*, Queen Mary University of London, February 27, 2025.
- ◆ *At least “at least” shifts the question*, ZAS / Humboldt University, January 28, 2025. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *How do Large Language Models process scalar Hurford Disjunctions?*, Harvard’s Language and Cognition Series, November 19, 2024. [\[Slides\]](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- ◆ “*Remind-me*” *presuppositions with iterated Speech Acts*, Theoretical Linguistics at Keio (TaLK): Semantics Conference, March 15, 2026, Tokyo, Japan. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *Repairing bad questions makes for good assertions: the case of but and at least*. The 61st annual meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS 61), May 10, 2025, University of Chicago, Chicago, USA. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *On the QuD-dependence of conditionals* [\[Poster\]](#)
 - ♥ 2025 Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, January 9-12, 2025, Philadelphia, USA.
 - ♥ CreteLing 2024, July 18, 2024, University of Crete, Rethymno, Greece.
- ◆ *A QuD-driven approach to incremental constraints on exhaustification*, Workshop in Honor of Irene Heim, December 7, 2024, MIT, Cambridge, MA, USA. [\[Poster\]](#)
- ◆ *A corpus study of the acquisition of French “se faire” passives*, 17th Conference on Syntax, Phonology and Language Analysis (SinFonIJA 17), September 26-28, 2024, Center for Cognitive Science of Language, Nova Gorica, Slovenia. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *Dealing with relevance and redundancy via a compositional model of QuDs*, BerlinBrnoVienna Workshop 2024, June 28, 2024, Masaryk University, Brno, Czech Republic. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *Morpho-semantics of the French diminutive suffix -et(te)* [\[Slides\]](#)
 - ♥ 16th Conference on Syntax, Phonology and Language Analysis (SinFonIJA 16), September 23, 2023, Masaryk University, Brno, Czech Republic.
 - ♥ International Symposium of Morphology (ISMo) 2023, September 15, 2023, Université de Lorraine & CNRS, Nancy, France.
- ◆ *Do Large Language Models learn the specificity of parasitic gaps?* Architectures and Mechanisms of Language Processing 2023 (AMLaP 29), August 31, 2023, Basque Center on Cognition, Brain and Language, Donostia-San Sebastián, Spain. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ *Versatile presuppositions in counterfactual conditionals*, Rencontres Autour de la Linguistique Formelle 2023 (RALFE 2023), May 25, 2023, Université Côte d’Azur, Nice, France. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ With Paul Egré, Benjamin Spector, and Steven Verheyen. *An experimental investigation of the around/between contrast*, Amsterdam Colloquium 2022 (AC2022), December 19, 2023, University of Amsterdam, the Netherlands. [\[Poster\]](#)[\[Manuscript\]](#)
- ◆ *A dynamic alternative-pruning account of asymmetries in Hurford disjunctions*, Student Session of the ESSLLI 2022, August 18, 2022, National University of Ireland, Galway, Ireland. [\[Slides\]](#)[\[Poster\]](#)
- ◆ *Evidence for an encoding of morphological blocking effects within two English word embedding models*. Architectures and Mechanisms of Language Processing 2022 (AMLaP 28), September 7, 2022, University of York, UK. [\[Poster\]](#)
- ◆ With Rachel Stacey, Cindy Torma and Athulya Aravind. *Two kinds of adjective-infinitive constructions in acquisition*, Architectures and Mechanisms of Language Processing 2022 (AMLaP 28), September 7, 2022, University of York, UK. [\[Slides\]](#)
- ◆ With Paul Egré, Benjamin Spector and Steven Verheyen. *Precisifying approximation: Around vs Between*, CreteLing 2022, July 21, 2022, University of Crete, Rethymno, Greece. [\[Poster\]](#)

- ♦ *It's tough to be pretty: semantic relatedness between tough and pretty predicates*, 45th Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW), April 28, 2022, Queen Mary University of London, London, UK. [\[Handout\]](#)[\[Manuscript\]](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

As main instructor:

- ♦ **Advanced Computational Linguistics** (MSc), QMUL Spring 2026
- ♦ **Syntax** (MA), QMUL Fall 2025
- ♦ **Foundations of Computational Linguistics** (MSc), QMUL Fall 2025

As guest lecturer:

- ♦ **Exploring AI: Understanding and Applications** (BSc), QMUL Spring 2026
- ♦ **Computational Psycholinguistics** (graduate & undergraduate), MIT Fall 2023

As teaching assistant:

- ♦ **Introduction to Syntax** (graduate & undergraduate), CreteLing Summer School Summer 2024
Instructor: Raffaella Zanuttini
- ♦ **Computational Psycholinguistics** (graduate & undergraduate), MIT Fall 2023
Instructor: Roger Levy
- ♦ **Introduction to Linguistics** (undergraduate), MIT Spring 2023
Instructor: Donca Steriade
- ♦ **Undergraduate Language Acquisition** (undergraduate), MIT Spring 2022
Instructor: Athulya Aravind
- ♦ **Introduction to Linguistics** (undergraduate), MIT Fall 2020
Instructor: Adam Albright

SERVICE

Grant Reviewing:

- ♦ UK Research and Innovation (UKRI) [Turing AI Pioneer Interdisciplinary Fellowships](#) (invite only).

Journal Reviewing:

- ♦ [Language Acquisition](#) Summer 2026 – present
- ♦ [Semantics and Pragmatics](#) Fall 2025 – present
- ♦ [Journal of Semantics](#) Spring 2025 – present
- ♦ [Snippets](#) Fall 2024 – present

Conference reviewing:

- ♦ *Syntax and Semantics Conference in Paris* (proceedings reviewing) Spring 2026 – present
- ♦ *Chicago Linguistic Society* (abstract reviewing) Spring 2026 – present
- ♦ *Sinn und Bedeutung* (abstract reviewing) Spring 2024 – present

- ♦ *Actes des Journées de linguistique* (proceedings reviewing) Spring 2023 – present

Other:

- ♦ MIT Working Papers in Linguistics staff Spring 2023 – Spring 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Intern @Heuritech Summer 2017 (3 months)
Benchmark of various clustering methods applied to image embeddings, for the purposes of image classification in the fashion industry.

Intern @Novossibirsk State University Summer 2016 (2 months)
Genome analysis of Parkinson and HCM patients, with the goal of identifying relevant mutations.

Intern @Novossibirsk State University Summer 2015 (2 months)
Modeling of within-host HIV infection using differential equations and optimization methods.

SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, L ^A T _E X (advanced), R, HTML, CSS, JavaScript (basic)
Natural languages	French (native), English (fluent), German, Russian (basic)

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- ♦ Life drawing
- ♦ Fixing bikes
- ♦ Collecting and repairing vintage Nintendos
- ♦ Biking, swimming, hiking